```
  }
}
```

❶ Rules to apply if there are no specific rules for a provider

❷ Rules to apply to the File provider

❸ Rules to apply to the Console provider

When creating your logging rules, the important thing to bear in mind is that if you have *any* provider-specific rules, these will take precedence over the category-based rules defined in the `"LogLevel"` section. Therefore, for the configuration defined in listing 26.7, if your app uses only the file or console logging providers, the rules in the `"LogLevel"` section will effectively never apply.

If you find this confusing, don't worry; so do I. Whenever I'm setting up logging, I check the algorithm used to determine which rule applies for a given provider and category, which is as follows:

1. Select all rules for the given provider. If no rules apply, select all rules that don't define a provider (the top `"LogLevel"` section from listing 26.7).
2. From the selected rules, select rules with the longest matching category prefix. If no selected rules match the category prefix, select the `"Default"` if present.
3. If multiple rules are selected, use the last one.
4. If no rules are selected, use the global minimum level, `"LogLevel:Default"` (`Debug` in listing 26.7).

Each of these steps except the last narrows down the applicable rules for a log message until you're left with a single rule. You saw this in effect for a `"Microsoft"` category log in figure 26.8. Figure 26.9 shows the process in more detail.